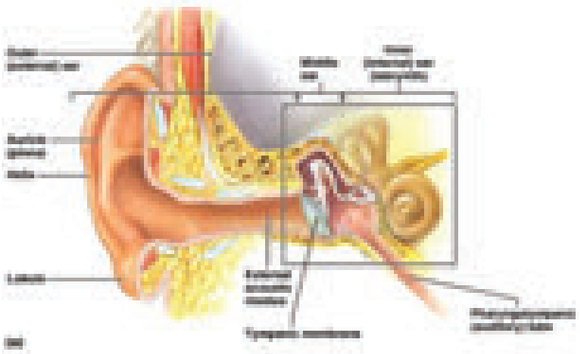
Ears



Ear

The ear is the organ for hearing. It is divided into three parts.

- Outer ear-pinna /auricle, auditory canal
- Middle ear-ear drum, ossicles, Eustachian tube
- Inner ear- cochlea, vestibule and semicircular canal.

The outer ear

Pinna: receives sound waves that travel the auditory canal or ear canal.

The curved formation on the outside [the pinna] helps funnel sound down the ear canal to the ear drum.

Auditory canal

Acts as a funnel and leads to the ear drum. which protects the eardrum from shock and intrusion by external objects.

Ear drum

- It is a cone shaped piece of skin.
- It is very sensitive, even the slightest pressure variation will cause it to vibrate.
- It is also separates the outer ear from the middle ear.

The middle ear

It transfer the energy of a sound wave by vibrating the three bones found there.

Ossicles:- smallest bone of the body. Ear bones are malleus, incus and stapes.

Eustacian tube

A tube that connects the middle ear to the back of the nose. It equalizes the pressure between the middle ear and the air outside.

The inner ear

It has two main parts.

Cochlea

This is a spiral that is covered in a stiff membrane. It contains thousands of hair cells attached to the end of the organ of the auditory nerve called organ of corti. These tiny hairs bend because of the vibrations caused by the sound waves.

The auditory nerve

The vibration from the hairs stimulated tiny nerve cells. The nerve cells then send signals along the auditory nerve to the brain.

Functions of Ear

Any source of sound sends vibrations or sound waves in to the air. These funnel through the ear opening, down the ear canal and strike eardrum acquiring in to vibrate. The vibrations become nerve impulses and transported to the brain, which interprets the impulses sound [music, voice, etc.]

Tongue

Tongue is a muscular organ situated in the floor of the mouth. It is associated with the function of taste, speech, mastication, degurtition.

Parts of the tongue

- Root
- Tip
- Body – it consists of two
- Dorsum – oral part
- Pharyngeal part
- Posterior part
- Inferior – inferior surface.

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